

If you are unable to find work, you may start leaning too heavily on your credit cards, or worse, crawl back to Mom and Dad and ask if you can move back into your childhood bedroom. And nobody—not you, not me, not your parents—wants that.

Best of luck. You're going to need it.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Uncle Kevin', with a stylized, cursive script.

Uncle Kevin

Money Mistake: *No One Will Hire You*

The Fix: *Embrace the New Reality—Adjust!*

There is some probability that you're not going to get a full-time job the traditional way. And you may not *want* a traditional job—maybe the idea of cubicles and business suits makes your little Generation Y stomach squirm. Or maybe you've been pounding the pavement, trying like hell to get work. Either way, it's time you came to terms with the fact that the world looks different today than it did when your parents were in their 20s. Youth unemployment is currently at a sky-high 19.6 percent, the highest level in 15 years.

What does that mean for you? You're going to have to create your own opportunities. Your 20s are not a time to slack off—far from it. Eleanor Roosevelt and Spider-Man both agree that with great freedom comes great responsibility. But the inverse is also true: with great responsibility comes great freedom. If you have a skill set, find a way to monetize it. You might end up as a freelancer, hustling for a constant flow of part-time work. Or perhaps you'll find a niche as a consultant. A lot of 20-somethings work as temps—in 2012, 29 percent of Canadians between the ages of 20 and 24 were employed in temporary positions. This can be a great way to work in a variety